

Problem Statement: Bridging Fragmented Court Systems

The Challenge: Modern courts are swamped – judges average ~58 hearings a week and ~18% of hearings are delayed[1] – yet many processes are still stuck in the 20th century. Litigants often juggle multiple siloed e-filing portals, repeatedly re-entering case data or uploading PDFs across different systems[2]. This duplication of effort not only wastes time but erodes trust (especially for self-represented litigants)[2]. For example, some state court managers report manually re-typing information from PDF filings because their digital systems don't "talk" to each other[2]. Meanwhile the global backlog of cases is staggering – India alone has ~53 million pending cases[3] – so inefficiency here literally means *years* of delay for real people.



Figure: Empty courtroom with judges' bench and unfilled seats. Outdated processes and paperwork-heavy workflows contribute to serious delays in hearings[1][2].

The Gap: Despite cloud services and AI hype, court management tech remains fragmented. A recent court survey found that **75% of judges don't use any digital evidence system**, even though most agree it would speed proceedings[4]. Staffing shortages are worsening, yet courts lack tools to offload basic tasks. Meanwhile, citizens need *anytime/anywhere* access to file documents, check case status, or get guidance – something mobile-friendly and intuitive. In short, we lack a **unified, user-centric justice platform** that ties together filing, case tracking, notifications and legal info across multiple courts and agencies.

Proposed Solution: We propose to build an **Integrated Case Management Portal** that acts as a one-stop self-service hub for litigants and court staff. This platform would:

- **Aggregate Multiple Courts:** Allow users to log in once and access all relevant court

systems (e.g. municipal, district, or appellate) in one dashboard.

- **Automate Data Entry:** Use smart forms or document parsing so that data entered for one filing auto-populates other linked systems, eliminating duplicate entry[2].
- **Mobile-First Interface:** Provide a smooth smartphone app or responsive site (the current mobile e-filing experience is often “far worse” than desktop[5]).
- **Case Tracking & Alerts:** Send automated reminders in local languages for upcoming hearings, filings due, or verdicts issued (tackling the #1 delay cause: no-shows[1]).
- **Analytics Dashboard:** Offer high-level metrics (e.g. case clearance rates, average time to resolution) to boost transparency and help courts identify bottlenecks.

Measurable Goals: The team should demonstrate that the solution can significantly cut manual work and delays. For instance: reducing average filing time by **≥50%** compared to existing multi-portal workflows, and lowering clerical re-entry errors by **>80%** (in tests where users file simulated cases). Success might also be measured by user satisfaction surveys (aiming for a positive usability rating) and by showing at least one court’s data (e.g. backlog or no-show rate) improve during a trial.

Why It’s Unique: Unlike generic legal research tools, this idea focuses on *operational efficiency and user access* in the justice system. To our knowledge, no single platform yet seamlessly links diverse court case management systems into one workflow. By combining integration, AI-driven form handling, and mobile notifications, this project tackles real pain points documented in court studies[2][1]. It goes beyond on-paper filing or siloed e-filing by delivering *justice-as-a-service* – a unified portal that speeds up proceedings, boosts transparency, and makes courts more accessible in a tangible, user-friendly way.

References: Contemporary court reports highlight these gaps: **clerks re-type PDF filings** and **poor mobile interfaces** hamper efficiency[2]; courts see **e-filing and virtual hearings** as key tech wins but still struggle with basic workflow issues[1]. Our problem statement directly addresses these documented challenges.

[1] [4] Court efficiency: How legal technology alleviates delays

<https://legal.thomsonreuters.com/blog/using-legal-technology-to-alleviate-delays/>

[2] [5] free.law

<https://free.law/pdf/Problems-Court-Filing-CMS-Perspectives-from-Advocates-and-Vendors.pdf>

[3] The missing infrastructure for India’s eCourts vision: How Jupitice fills the gap

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